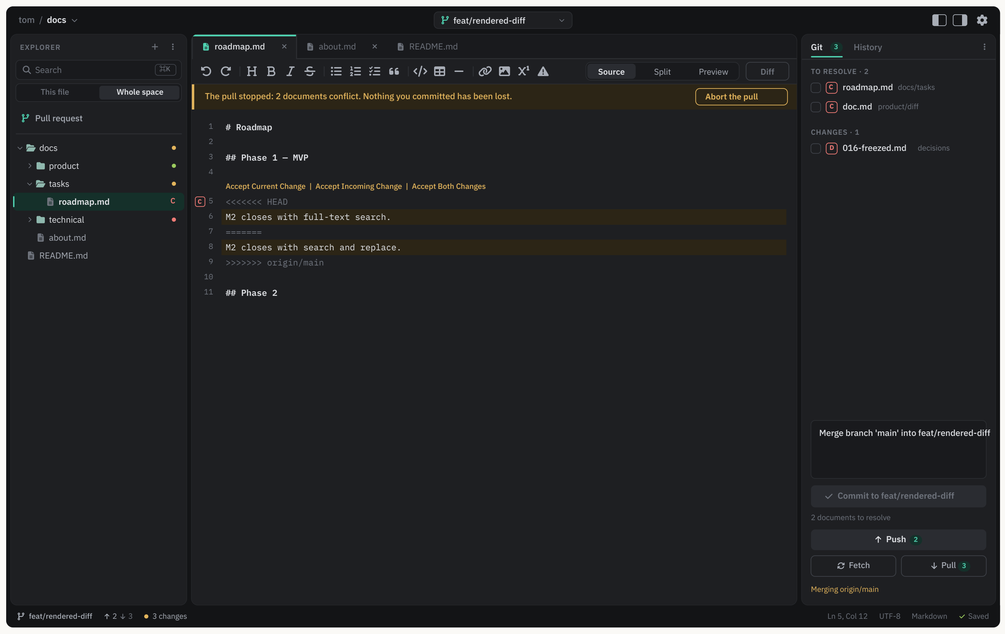
Git · conflict

A pull that stopped in the middle, and the two ways out of it.

Conflict in source



The markers are what git wrote

`<<<<<<< HEAD`, `=======` and `>>>>>>>` stay on screen as real, selectable text. Somebody who resolves conflicts in a terminal has to recognise what they are looking at.

Both sides carry the same tint

`removed` would say your work is leaving and `added` would say theirs has arrived, and neither is true until somebody chooses.

A conflicted document is C

The same letter in the tree and in the changes list, the fifth of the alphabet the tree already uses.

And it cannot be staged

A marker committed into documentation is read by everyone who opens the file next, so the box is empty and stays empty.

Conflict in preview

No marker ever appears here

The region becomes two groups, Current Change and Incoming Change, rendered as markdown over the block containers the preview already draws.

Three choices, because that is what the situation has

The one who wrote first, the one who wrote after, and the two that turn out not to disagree.

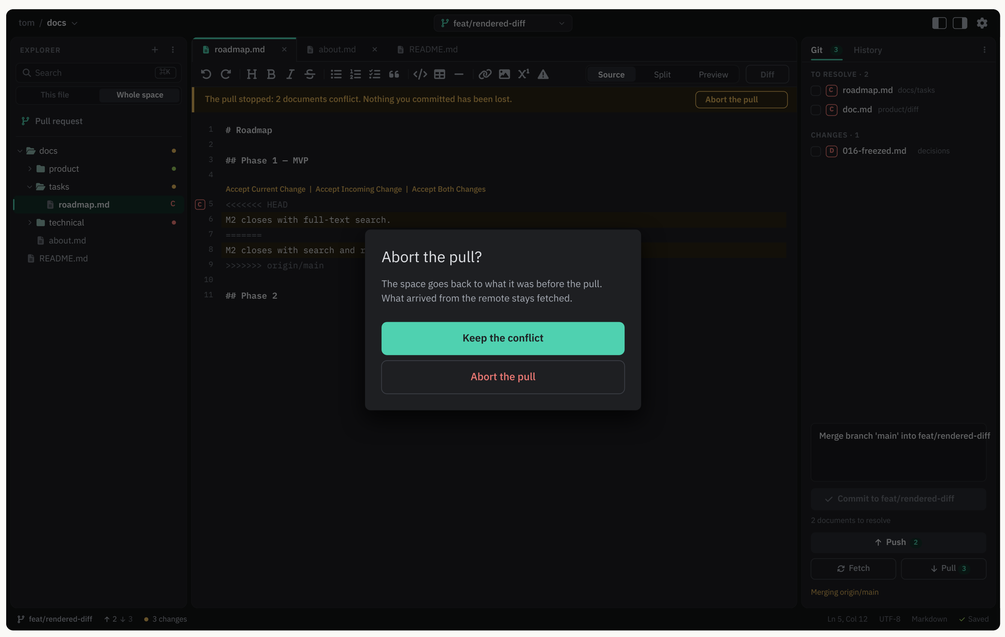
A choice is an edit, not a save

It rewrites the buffer: the unsaved mark appears and undo puts it back. The file on disk changes when somebody saves it.

Every mode stays open

The preview is the easier way to read a conflict, not a mode the app switches anybody into, and not one it takes away.

Aborting the pull



The band has one action

Resolving is editing the document, and nothing in this band resolves anything.

The confirmation says what it undoes

The space returns to what it was before the pull, and what arrived from the remote stays fetched.

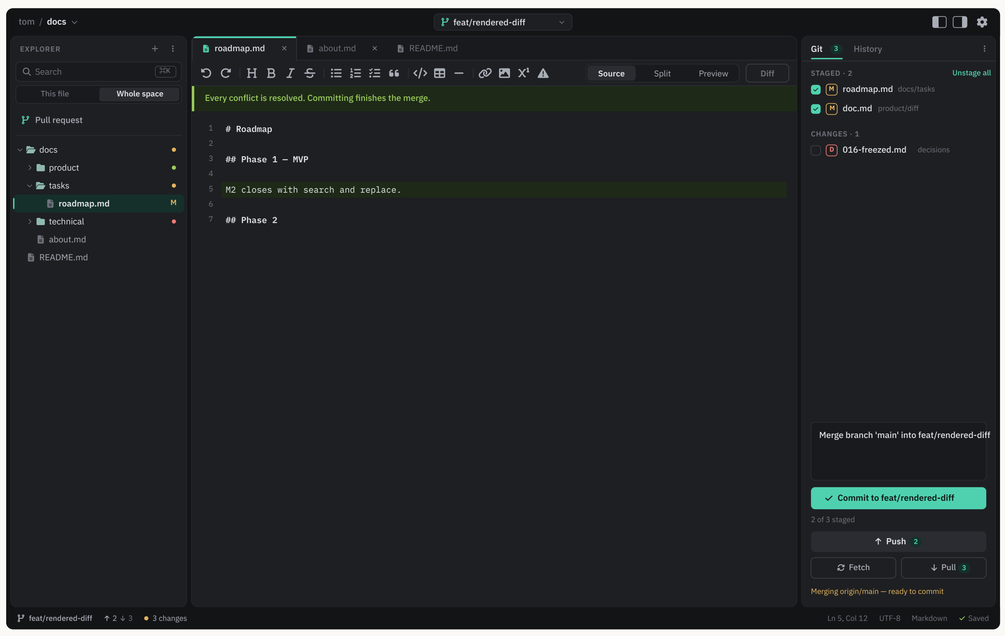
The state belongs to the repository

It survives the window being closed and reopened, so it is read from git rather than remembered from the action that caused it.

Concluding the merge is a commit

Not a fourth button: the box arrives filled with the message git already wrote, editable like any other.

Merge resolved



Resolved is not committed

With no marker left in any document the boxes can be ticked again, and the merge ends the way every other change does — with a commit.

The message arrives already written

Git wrote MERGE_MSG, so the box is filled before anybody types, and it stays editable like any other message.

The count runs down to nothing

Two documents to resolve becomes none, and the commit button stops being disabled. The words change, not only the colour.

The way out lasts until the commit

Aborting is still offered while the merge is unfinished, because until it is concluded nothing has been decided.